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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Answer Scheme - MG4DSESMG200 - BECOMING ASPORTS AGENT

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A-Short Answer

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 2 marks

1. Explain the main responsibilities of early sports agencies.

Ans: Early sports agencies primarily focused on basic player representation and contract negotiation. Their core responsibilities revolved around securing fair salaries for athletes from sports teams, managing basic endorsement deals, and booking players for promotional public appearances.

2. List two key benefits of effective networking.

Ans:

- Career Advancement & Opportunities: Access to hidden job markets, internships, and unadvertised executive roles within sports organizations.
- Resource and Knowledge Sharing: Gaining industry insights, market intelligence, and collaborative partnerships from senior professionals.

3. Who are key stakeholders involved in Indian professional sports?

Ans: The key stakeholders include governing bodies (e.g., BCCI, AIFF), franchise owners (e.g., IPL/ISL team owners), athletes and coaches, broadcasters/media networks (e.g., Star Sports, JioCinema), sponsors/brands, and the fans/consumers.

4. Explain why athlete representation requirements differ in Golf.

Ans: Unlike team sports where agents negotiate fixed salaries with clubs, golf is an individual sport. Representation differs because golfers rely entirely on sponsorship endorsements, tournament appearance fees, and performance-based prize money, requiring agents to focus heavily on brand management and commercial deals rather than collective bargaining contracts.

5. Discuss how data analytics is used in the sports industry.

Ans: Data analytics is split into two major domains:

- On-field (Performance Analytics): Tracking player metrics, scouting talent, and developing game strategies.
- Off-field (Business Analytics): Dynamic ticket pricing, fan engagement optimization, and evaluating sponsorship return on investment (ROI).

6. Differentiate between primary and secondary sources of market intelligence.

Ans:

- Primary Sources: First-hand data collected directly from the source for a specific purpose (e.g., fan surveys, focus groups, direct interviews with stakeholders).
- Secondary Sources: Pre-existing data compiled by external entities for other purposes (e.g., published industry reports, financial news, academic journals).

7. Explain how retirement can affect an athlete's identity.

Ans: Retirement often triggers an identity crisis or "athletic identity foreclosure." Because athletes spend their entire lives defining themselves solely by their sport, sudden retirement can lead to a loss of purpose, social status, and structure, occasionally resulting in psychological distress if transition planning is absent.

8. Identify the primary sport or domain associated with Rahul Johri.

Ans: The primary sport is Cricket, and his domain is Sports Administration & Media Rights. Rahul Johri famously served as the first-ever Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) from 2016 to 2020.

9. List two ethical responsibilities of a sports agent.

Ans:

- Fiduciary Duty: Acting strictly in the best financial and professional interests of the athlete, maintaining absolute transparency regarding fees.
- Conflict of Interest Avoidance: Refusing to represent multiple players or parties whose interests directly clash without explicit disclosure and consent.

10. Define dispute resolution in sports.

Ans: Dispute resolution in sports refers to the structured mechanisms—such as arbitration, mediation, and internal disciplinary panels—used to resolve legal, contractual, or disciplinary conflicts between athletes, clubs, and governing bodies without resorting to traditional, lengthy court litigation.

11. Define cross-border contract in sports.

Ans:A cross-border contract is a legally binding agreement in which the contracting parties (e.g., an athlete and a sports club or sponsor) are operating under or based in different national jurisdictions. A common example is an Indian football player signing a transfer contract with a European club.

12. Explain how networking supports job opportunities.

Ans: Networking bridges the gap between professionals, allowing job seekers to Tap into the "hidden job market." It establishes professional credibility through word-of-mouth recommendations, ensuring that when sports franchises or agencies look to hire, networked individuals are prioritized based on trusted industry referrals.

Part B -Short Essay

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

13. An athlete receives multiple endorsement offers. How should the agent decide

which brand to choose?

Ans: An agent should evaluate the offer's financial value, contract length, and alignment with the athlete's personal values and long-term brand identity. They must assess the company's market reputation and verify that the partnership does not create a conflict of interest with pre-existing endorsement deals.

14. Summarize the compliance responsibilities of professional athletes.

Ans: Professional athletes must comply with anti-doping regulations (such as WADA guidelines), local tax laws, and governing body codes of conduct. They are also responsible for fulfilling contractual obligations to team owners and sponsors, including mandatory promotional appearances, media duties, and adherence to team-specific uniform policies.

15. Explain how agent fees are structured in professional sports.

Ans: Sports agent fees are typically structured as a percentage of the athlete's earnings. Agents generally charge 3% to 5% for team contract negotiations, while marketing and commercial endorsement deals command a higher rate, usually ranging between 10% and 20%. Some agents charge hourly or flat fees for legal advice.

16. Illustrate how a sports agent can manage Shikhar Dhawan's public relations.

Ans: An agent can highlight Dhawan's transition into showbiz—like his hosting roles and broadcast appearances—alongside his philanthropic foundation to craft a strong

"post-retirement" narrative. Emphasizing his signature vibrant personality, family milestones, and mentorship of young cricketers on social media maintains a highly positive, authentic, and marketable public image.

17. Explain the negotiation strategies an agent might use to secure better financial

terms for an athlete.

Ans: Agents maximize financial terms by using data analytics, highlighting the athlete's performance metrics and marketability to build leverage. They create competition by pursuing multiple interested franchises or brands simultaneously. Furthermore, agents secure future income by structuring back-ended bonuses, performance incentives, and guaranteed clauses into the final contract.

18. Discuss the need for savings during peak earning years.

Ans: The professional athletic window is short and highly unpredictable due to sudden injury risks or loss of form. Maximizing savings and long-term investments during peak earning years ensures financial security for the athlete, funding their lifestyle and smooth career transition into a second vocation after retirement.

19. Demonstrate how wearable technology can be used to monitor athlete health.

Ans: Wearable devices like GPS trackers, smartwatches, and biometrics rings continuously log an athlete's heart rate variability, sleep patterns, and workload stress. Sports scientists and medical staff analyze this real-time data to flag early signs of overtraining, optimize recovery protocols, and customize training loads to minimize injury risks.

20. Analyze why endurance sports require higher aerobic capacity.

Ans: Endurance sports demand a higher aerobic capacity because the muscles require a steady, continuous supply of oxygen to sustain prolonged physical exertion. A highly developed cardiovascular system efficiently delivers oxygen to moving muscles, delaying the onset of fatigue and metabolic waste accumulation.

Part C-Essay

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 10 marks

21. Discuss the structure and purpose of salary caps in professional sportsleagues.

Ans: A salary cap sets a regulatory limit on the total money a team can spend on player payroll. It can be structured as a **hard cap**, which strictly forbids exceeding the limit (e.g., NFL), or a **soft cap**, which allows teams to breach the limit through specific exceptions while paying a luxury tax penalty (e.g., NBA).

The primary purpose is twofold: maintaining **competitive balance (parity)** by stopping wealthy, large-market franchises from hoarding all the top talent, and ensuring **financial stability** by preventing clubs from overspending themselves into bankruptcy for short-term success.

22. Apply financial management principles to design a retirement plan for anathlete.

Ans: Designing a sustainable retirement plan for athletes requires anchoring wealth management in structured diversification due to their compressed, high-earning career windows:

- **Liquidity and Emergency Buffer:** Establish a safe, liquid cash reserve equivalent to 1–2 years of living expenses to buffer against sudden, career-ending injuries.
- **Core Income Generation:** Channel 40–50% of peak earnings into conservative, long-term compounding instruments (like high-grade bonds or dividend-yielding mutual funds) to substitute for lost active income later.
- **Growth and Alternative Assets:** Allocate remaining capital toward real estate, private equity, or business ventures to keep pace with inflation.
- **Tax and Post-Career Shielding:** Use trust structures and tax-advantaged annuities to protect assets, while simultaneously budgeting for a "second-career" vocational transition.

23. Analyse the international transfer system in the global sports market.

Ans: The international transfer system regulates the global movement of athletes between clubs across different national jurisdictions, famously governed in football by **FIFA's Regulations on the Status and Transfer of Players (RSTP)**. When an athlete moves, the buying club pays a negotiated **transfer fee** to buy out the remaining duration of the player's employment contract.

The system utilizes mandatory digital verification platforms—like the **FIFA Transfer Matching System (TMS)**—to ensure financial transparency and handle international transfer certificates. Crucially, it redistributes money down the sports ecosystem

through solidarity mechanisms and training compensation paid to grassroots academies that developed the athlete early on.

24. Explain how to prepare and organize the essential documentation required forobtaining sports licensing.

Ans: Organizing the necessary documentation for sports licensing—whether for a franchise, event, or commercial product—requires an audited, multi-layered compliance portfolio:

- **Legal and Corporate Records:** Compile foundational business registration documents, articles of association, and proof of ownership or power of attorney.
- **Financial Audits:** Assemble certified financial statements, tax clearance certificates, bank guarantees, and comprehensive liability insurance policies to prove solvency.
- **Operational and Technical Assets:** Prepare venue safety certifications, security blueprints, and medical emergency response protocols.
- **Intellectual Property (IP):** Include trademark registrations, brand guidelines, and explicitly drafted third-party rights clearance agreements to ensure the entire licensing package passes regulatory screening smoothly.